Workplace Essential Skills

Project Planning

Core Concept: Project planning is a critical phase of project management where a formal, structured plan is created to guide the execution, control, and closure of a project. It transforms an idea into a clear, actionable roadmap.

The Five Phases of Project Management:

1. **Initiation:** Define project at a high level. Key output: **Project Charter**.
2. **Planning:** Develop detailed roadmap. Key output: **Project Management Plan**.
3. **Execution:** Carry out the work.
4. **Monitoring & Controlling:** Track progress and manage changes.
5. **Closing:** Finalize and hand over the project.

Components of a Project Plan & Key Vocabulary:

1. **Project Charter:** The foundational document that formally authorizes the project. It includes:
    - **Scope:** What is included (and excluded) in the project.
    - **Objectives/Goals:** What the project aims to achieve.
    - **Key Stakeholders:** Individuals/groups affected by the project.
    - **Project Manager Authority:** The decision-making power granted.
    - **High-level Budget & Risks.**
2. **Project Schedule:** A timeline listing all project activities, **deliverables**, and milestones. It shows planned start/finish dates, duration, dependencies, and assigned resources.
3. **Resource Allocation Plan:** A detailed list of all resources needed (Human, Material, Equipment, Financial, Time), specifying when they are needed, in what quantity, and at what cost. It ensures resources are used efficiently.

4. **Risk Management Plan:** A proactive approach to identifying, analyzing, and responding to project risks. The process includes:
    - **Risk Identification:** Listing potential risks.
    - **Risk Analysis:** Assessing **Probability** (Likelihood) and **Impact** (Severity).
    - **Risk Response Planning:** Deciding actions (**Avoid, Mitigate, Transfer, Accept**).
    - **Contingency Plans:** Backup plans if a risk occurs.
5. **Communication Plan:** An outline of how project information will be shared. It specifies **who** needs **what** information, **when**, and **how** (method/frequency).
6. **Quality Assurance (QA) Plan:** A document outlining the procedures to ensure project outputs meet required standards. It defines **quality objectives, criteria, roles, activities** (like testing and reviews), and the process for **continuous improvement**.